

License Lifecycle Hub — User Guide

Welcome to the **License Lifecycle Hub** user guide. This document provides a clear, step-by-step overview of how to use the application to track software licenses, cloud subscriptions, certificates, and renewal timelines.

Table of Contents

1. [Getting Started & Sign In](#)
 2. [User Roles & Permissions](#)
 3. [Dashboard & Analytics Overview](#)
 4. [Managing License & Subscription Records](#)
 5. [Excel Import & Export](#)
 6. [System Controls & Threshold Settings](#)
 7. [Custom Fields & Rules Engine](#)
 8. [Notification Email Service](#)
 9. [User Access Management \(Admins\)](#)
 10. [Account & Password Management](#)
 11. [Help & Support Contact](#)
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1. Getting Started & Sign In

Access the application through your web browser at <https://licensehub-bedychavezbuh5cg.westeurope-01.azurewebsites.net>.

Authentication Options

- **Microsoft Outlook SSO:** Click "**Sign in with Microsoft Outlook**" to log in seamlessly using your corporate Microsoft account.
 - **User Credentials:** If you were provided a username/email and password by the system administrator, enter your **Username or Email** and **Password**, then click **Enter dashboard**.
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2. User Roles & Permissions

Access level is determined by your assigned role:

Feature / Action	Admin	Operations (ops)	Viewer (viewer)
View Dashboard & Registers	✓	✓	✓
Search, Filter & Sort Records	✓	✓	✓
Export Register to Excel	✓	✓	✓
Create / Edit License Records	✓	✓	✗
Delete License Records	✓	✗	✗
Import Excel Workbooks	✓	✓	✗
Configure System Controls & Custom Fields	✓	✓	✗
User Access Management (Add/Delete/Roles)	✓	✗	✗

3. Dashboard & Analytics Overview

Upon logging in, the main dashboard presents a centralized view of your organization's software lifecycle:

Key Performance Indicators (KPI Tiles)

- **Total Items:** Total count of tracked licenses and certificates.
- **Expired Items:** Licenses past their expiration date (marked in red).
- **Urgent Renewals:** Records expiring within the urgent threshold (default: 30 days).
- **Missing Expiry Info:** Records requiring expiration dates or audit reviews.
- **Active Items:** Healthy licenses currently in use.
- **In-Review Items:** Licenses approaching review threshold (default: 60 days).
- **Total Annual Cost:** Aggregated financial commitment across all active items.

Interactive Visualizations

- **Expiry Timeline:** Line chart forecasting upcoming record expirations month-by-month.
- **Category Mix:** Donut chart displaying the distribution of items across categories (e.g., Cloud, Infrastructure, SaaS).
- **Risk Panel:** Highlights top-priority items needing immediate action or renewal.
- **Utilization Heatmap:** Identifies under-utilized (<20%) or over-utilized (>100%) licenses.
- **Predictive Insights:** Displays forecasted renewal costs, missing metadata counts, and spend at risk.
- **Audit Trail:** Real-time log showing recent updates, actors, and value changes.

4. Managing License & Subscription Records

Viewing & Filtering the Register

- **Search Bar:** Search across client name, vendor, product, owner, email, or license reference.
- **Status Filter:** Filter by `Active` , `Review` , `Urgent` , `Expired` , Or `Missing Expiry Info` .
- **Category Filter:** Filter by specific operational category.
- **Sorting:** Click any sort chip (`Sort by days to expiry` , `Sort by utilization %` , `Sort by annual cost` , `Sort by priority` , `Sort by status`) to toggle ascending/descending order.

Adding a New Record (Admin & Ops)

1. Click **New Record** in the top navigation bar.
2. Fill in the required fields:
3. **Client:** Target client or organization unit.
4. **Vendor & Product/Service:** E.g., *Microsoft, Office 365 E5*.
5. **Category:** E.g., *SaaS, Security, Infrastructure*.
6. **Quantities & Costs:** Units purchased, units in use, unit cost, and annual cost.
7. **Dates:** Start date, expiry date, and End-of-Life (EOL) date.
8. **Ownership:** Primary owner, renewal owner, technical contact, and notification email.
9. Click **Save Record**.

Editing or Deleting a Record

- **Edit:** Click the  **Edit** icon on any row to open the editing drawer.
- **Delete (Admin only):** Click the  **Delete** icon on a row and confirm deletion.

5. Excel Import & Export

Exporting Data

Click **Export** in the top bar to instantly download the complete license register as a formatted Excel spreadsheet (`.xlsx`).

Importing Data (Admin & Ops)

1. Click **Import** in the top bar and select an Excel file (`.xlsx`).
2. The system automatically processes rows, updating existing items and adding new entries.
3. Once completed, a summary banner will display the results (e.g., *Imported 5, updated 60, skipped 2*).

4. If warnings or validation defaults occurred, click **View Log** on the banner to open a detailed breakdown of all log entries.
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6. System Controls & Threshold Settings

Admins and Operations users can click **Controls** in the top bar to configure global operational settings:

- **Urgent Days Threshold:** Days remaining before a record is flagged as Urgent (default: 30 days).
 - **Review Days Threshold:** Days remaining before a record enters Review status (default: 60 days).
 - **EOL Soon Threshold:** Lead time for End-of-Life warnings (default: 90 days).
 - **Base Currency:** Select primary currency (e.g., `USD` , `EUR` , `GBP` , `AED`).
 - **Options Lists:** Edit line-separated lists for Categories, Item Types, Environments, Renewal Cycles, and Priorities.
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7. Custom Fields & Rules Engine

Located inside the **Controls** dialog:

Custom Fields

Add custom metadata columns to your register (e.g., *PO Number*, *Business Unit*, *Compliance Audit Date*):

- Supported types: `Text` , `Number` , `Date` , `Yes/No (Boolean)` , and `Dropdown (Select)` . - Custom fields automatically appear in the main data table and in record creation/edit forms.

Custom Rules Engine

Create automated IF-THEN conditions: - **IF:** Define conditions based on Expiry Days, Utilization %, Annual Cost, Category, or Status. - **THEN:** Trigger automated actions such as setting priority to `Critical` , flagging risk labels, or boosting anomaly scores.

8. Notification Email Service

The **Notification Email Service** delivers real-time email alerts and status notifications to record owners and administrators to ensure renewal deadlines and risk flags are addressed proactively.

System Configuration & Delivery

- **Backend Integration:** Automated email notifications are handled asynchronously by the backend service. Delivery runs in non-blocking background threads so user interactions and API response

times remain fast.

- **SMTP Settings:** Email delivery requires SMTP configuration in environment variables (`SMTP_ENABLED=true` , `SMTP_HOST` , `SMTP_PORT` , `SMTP_USERNAME` , `SMTP_PASSWORD` , `SMTP_FROM_EMAIL`). If SMTP is disabled or misconfigured, notification errors are logged silently without interrupting system operations.
- **Recipient Targeting:** Notifications are dispatched to the addresses configured in the **Notification Email** field of each license record. Multiple recipient emails can be specified using comma or semicolon separation.

Trigger Events (When Emails Are Sent)

The system automatically triggers email notifications under the following conditions:

1. **New Email Subscription Confirmation**
2. **Trigger:** When a **Notification Email** address is added to a license record for the first time.
3. **Content:** Welcome confirmation email detailing the tracked client, vendor, product/service, status, and expiration date.
4. **License Record Updates**
5. **Trigger:** When an existing license record with configured notification email(s) is modified by an Admin or Operations user.
6. **Content:** Notification specifying who updated the record (actor email), current status and expiration date, and a bulleted list of changed fields.
7. **Critical Status Transitions (`Urgent` or `Expired`)**
8. **Trigger:** When a record's status transitions to **Urgent** (e.g., within the 30-day renewal threshold) or **Expired** (upon record creation, manual update, or automated recalculation).
9. **Content:** High-priority alert highlighting previous status, new status, expiration date, and days remaining to renew.
10. **Risk Flags Raised**
11. **Trigger:** When system evaluation, custom rules, or updates detect new risk conditions (e.g., *under-utilized*, *approaching-eol*, *missing-expiry*, or *high-cost-risk*).
12. **Content:** Risk warning displaying all newly raised risk flags alongside record priority and expiration details.
13. **Automated Rules Engine Alerts (`notify_owner` Action)**

14. **Trigger:** When a custom rule in the Rules Engine executes a `notify_owner` action, or when records are imported via Excel containing `notify-owner` risk flags.
15. **Content:** Action-required email notification directing owners to review the flagged record.
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9. User Access Management (Admins)

Admins can click **Users** in the top bar to manage user accounts:

- **View Registered Users:** Inspect full names, usernames/emails, registration dates, and assigned access levels.
 - **Change Access Levels:** Use the dropdown next to any user to switch their role between `Admin`, `Operations`, or `Viewer`.
 - **Add New User:** Click **Add User**, enter Full Name, Username/Email, Password, and Role, then click **Create User**.
 - **Delete User:** Click the red  trash icon next to a user to permanently remove their account (self-deletion is blocked for security).
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10. Account & Password Management

- **Theme Toggle:** Click the  /  icon in the top navigation bar to switch between Light Mode and Dark Mode.
 - **Change Password (Local Credentials):** Click the  **Key** icon in the top bar, enter your current password and your new password, then click **Change Password**. *(Note: Microsoft SSO users manage their credentials directly through Microsoft).*
 - **Sign Out:** Click the  **Logout** icon in the top right to end your session.
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11. Help & Support Contact

If you encounter issues, require access level modifications, or need technical assistance with the License Lifecycle Hub, please reach out to:

- **System Administrator / Support Team:** marwa.saleh@vertowave.com
 - **Application Portal:** [License Lifecycle Hub on Azure](#)
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License Lifecycle Hub — Centralized license, certificate, and renewal tracking.